

Trampled over: On the RCB cup celebration and Bengaluru stampede

Poor communication and bad policing **led to** the **stampede** in Bengaluru

In less than 24 hours, **ecstasy turned into despair**. Royal Challengers Bengaluru's (RCB) **maiden** Indian Premier League (IPL) **title, secured** on Tuesday night (June 3, 2025) in Ahmedabad, **triggered unabated** joy and **raucous** celebrations in Bengaluru and the rest of Karnataka. However, by Wednesday evening (June 4, 2025), a thick **shroud of grief hung over** the southern metropolis as a **ghastly** stampede in and around RCB's home ground, the M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, left 11 dead and more than 50 injured. The **hallowed venue** was hosting a **felicitation** event in honour of the victorious team while fans outside, **desperate to get in, ended up** as a **heaving chaotic** mass with many **gasping for** breath. **Asphyxia** was the primary cause of death besides injuries suffered in the **stifling rush**. Sport is **often** a tight **pact** between the performing athlete and the **adoring** fan; it **triggers** emotions, and in the case of the IPL, **forges** a connection between the **franchise** and a vast audience. RCB has always had a loyal fan base, and the IPL **triumph** was bound to attract followers running into lakhs, towards the Central Business District of M.G. Road, Brigade Road, Cubbon Road, Queens Road and KSCA Clubhouse Link Road. Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah **admitted** that the crowd was beyond expectations.

However, **to use** a massive **gathering** as an explanation for an avoidable accident, **is** unacceptable. The **multitude** of fans near the Vidhana Soudha, the State legislature, from Wednesday morning (June 4, 2025) **should** have **compelled** the authorities to **tighten** crowd control **protocols**. RCB had **proclaimed** that there would be an open-bus parade, but the police clarified that it would not happen. With no access to the Vidhana Soudha where the Chief Minister **felicitated** the players, the **frenzied** gathering **rushed** towards the stadium for a **glimpse** of stars such as Virat Kohli. The **rumours** about the gates being open to the public, and the **contradictory** messages about entry by invitation only, **exacerbated** the crisis. As the venue was **packed**, gates were closed but fans tried to **force their way** in. **Be it** the Karnataka State Cricket Association's (KSCA) security or police personnel, staffing was inadequate and a **fatal climax** was **inevitable**. The State Government, the RCB management, the KSCA and the BCCI have expressed their **condolences** while some have **indulged** in **finger-pointing**. The Chief Minister has announced that the Bengaluru Police Commissioner and all officials responsible for the **jurisdiction** where the stadium is have been suspended, pending an inquiry. There will also be a judicial inquiry. However, the **grim** truth is that **the fan**, who **drives** the **commerce** of every sport, **is** the last priority for administrators. Clear communication, effective policing and proper advance notice for an event of this scale are all **essential** or else, such tragedies might **recur** periodically.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[Practice Exercise]

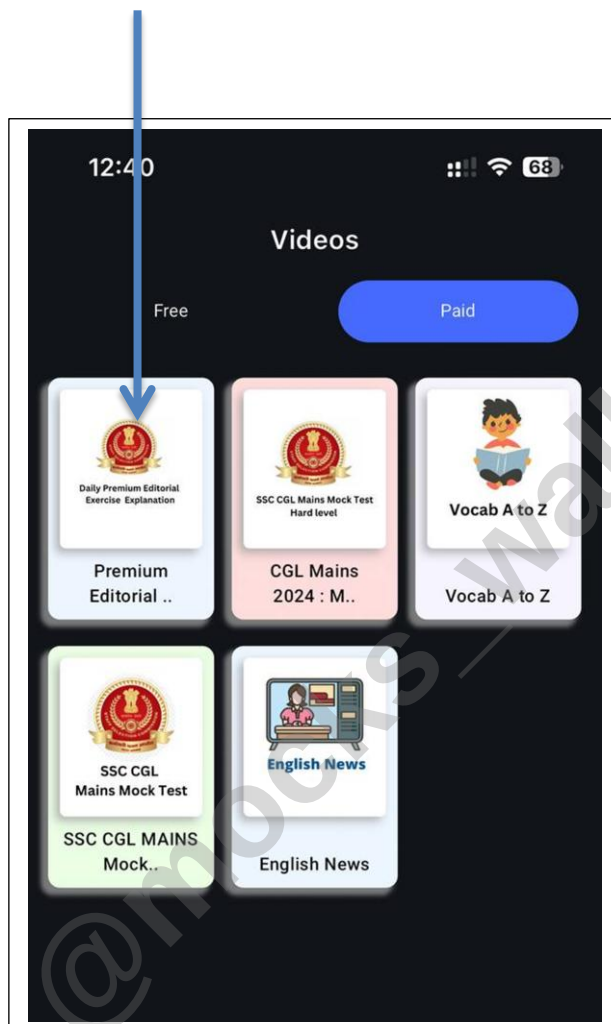
Vocabulary

1. **Trample** (verb) – crush, stomp, squash, flatten, tread कुचलना
2. **Stampede** (noun) – rush, surge, charge, scramble, crush भगदड़
3. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, cause, bring about, prompt, generate कारण बनना
4. **Ecstasy** (noun) – bliss, euphoria, delight, elation, joy अत्यधिक आनंद
5. **Turn into** (phrasal verb) – become, convert, transform, change into, evolve into में बदल जाना
6. **Despair** (noun) – hopelessness, misery, anguish, dejection, gloom निराशा
7. **Maiden** (adjective) – first, initial, introductory, inaugural, debut पहली
8. **Secure** (verb) – obtain, acquire, win, gain, achieve प्राप्त करना
9. **Trigger** (verb) – cause, initiate, spark, provoke, prompt शुरू करना
10. **Unabated** (adjective) – undiminished, relentless, persistent, continuous, unceasing बिना रुके
11. **Raucous** (adjective) – noisy, boisterous, loud, rowdy, disorderly शोरगुल वाला
12. **Shroud** (noun) – cover, veil, cloak, blanket, layer आवरण
13. **Grief** (noun) – sorrow, anguish, sadness, heartache, misery दुःख
14. **Hung over** (phrasal verb) – linger, remain, persist, continue, stay छाया हुआ
15. **Ghastly** (adjective) – horrifying, dreadful, grim, appalling, terrible भयानक
16. **Hallowed** (adjective) – sacred, revered, holy, blessed, venerated पूजनीय
17. **Venue** (noun) – location, site, setting, place, arena स्थल
18. **Felicitation** (noun) – congratulation, celebration, honour, tribute, recognition सम्मान समारोह
19. **Desperate** (adjective) – frantic, anxious, eager, reckless, hopeless हताश
20. **Get in** (phrasal verb) – enter, access, arrive, come in, reach अंदर आना
21. **End up** (phrasal verb) – finish, land, result, conclude, arrive पहुँचना (अंततः)
22. **Heaving** (adjective) – crowded, packed, bustling, congested, thronging भीड़-भाड़ वाला
23. **Chaotic** (adjective) – disordered, turbulent, messy, confused, anarchic अराजक
24. **Gasp** (for) (verb) – struggle for breath, pant, wheeze, choke, puff हाँफना

25. **Asphyxia** (noun) – suffocation, breathlessness, choking, hypoxia, respiratory arrest श्वास रुकना
26. **Stifling** (adjective) – suffocating, oppressive, stuffy, airless, smothering दमघौटू
27. **Rush** (noun) – surge, stampede, burst, dash, hurry अचानक भीड़ या दौड़
28. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, habitually, commonly अक्सर
29. **Pact** (noun) – agreement, deal, treaty, contract, accord समझौता
30. **Adoring** (adjective) – loving, devoted, affectionate, worshipful, admiring प्यार करने वाला
31. **Trigger** (verb) – initiate, activate, set off, incite, cause शुरू करना
32. **Forge** (verb) – form, build, establish, develop, construct बनाना (रिश्ता आदि)
33. **Franchise** (noun) – team, club, organization, enterprise, entity टीम/संस्था
34. **Triumph** (noun) – victory, success, win, conquest, achievement जीत
35. **Admit** (verb) – acknowledge, confess, concede, accept, reveal स्वीकार करना
36. **Gathering** (noun) – crowd, assembly, congregation, group, meeting सभा
37. **Multitude** (noun) – mass, throng, host, swarm, crowd बड़ी संख्या
38. **Compel** (verb) – force, oblige, pressurize, require, coerce मजबूर करना
39. **Tighten** (verb) – strengthen, reinforce, secure, firm up, make strict कड़ा करना
40. **Protocol** (noun) – procedure, rule, code, system, guideline प्रोटोकॉल/नियम
41. **Proclaim** (verb) – announce, declare, state, pronounce, reveal घोषणा करना
42. **Felicitate** (verb) – honour, congratulate, praise, applaud, celebrate सम्मानित करना
43. **Frenzied** (adjective) – wild, frantic, hysterical, chaotic, mad उन्मादी
44. **Rush** (verb) – hurry, run, race, dash, bolt दौड़ना/भागना
45. **Glimpse** (noun) – sight, view, peek, glance, look झलक
46. **Rumour** (noun) – gossip, hearsay, report, buzz, speculation अफवाह
47. **Contradictory** (adjective) – conflicting, inconsistent, opposing, paradoxical, irreconcilable विरोधाभासी
48. **Exacerbate** (verb) – worsen, aggravate, intensify, heighten, inflame और बिगाड़ना
49. **Packed** (adjective) – crowded, full, jammed, crammed, stuffed भरा हुआ

50. **Force one's way** (phrase) – push through, barge in, squeeze in, struggle through, shove रास्ता बनाना (जबरदस्ती)
51. **Be it** (phrase) – whether it is, no matter if, regardless of चाहे वह हो...
52. **Fatal** (adjective) – deadly, lethal, mortal, catastrophic, terminal जानलेवा
53. **Climax** (noun) – peak, culmination, high point, finale, zenith चरम बिंदु
54. **Inevitable** (adjective) – unavoidable, certain, inescapable, fated, destined अपरिहार्य
55. **Condolence** (noun) – sympathy, commiseration, compassion, solace, mourning संवेदना
56. **Indulge** (verb) – engage, participate, yield to, take part in, entertain लिप्त होना
57. **Finger-pointing** (noun) – blame, accusation, scapegoating, criticism, fault-finding दोषारोपण
58. **Jurisdiction** (noun) – authority, control, power, dominion, governance अधिकार क्षेत्र
59. **Grim** (adjective) – bleak, harsh, gloomy, depressing, stern गंभीर/भयानक
60. **Drive** (verb) – propel, push, motivate, power, operate प्रेरित करना
61. **Commerce** (noun) – trade, business, economy, exchange, industry व्यापार
62. **Essential** (noun) – necessity, requirement, need, fundamental, prerequisite अनिवार्यता
63. **Recur** (verb) – repeat, reappear, happen again, return, resurface दोहराना/फिर होना

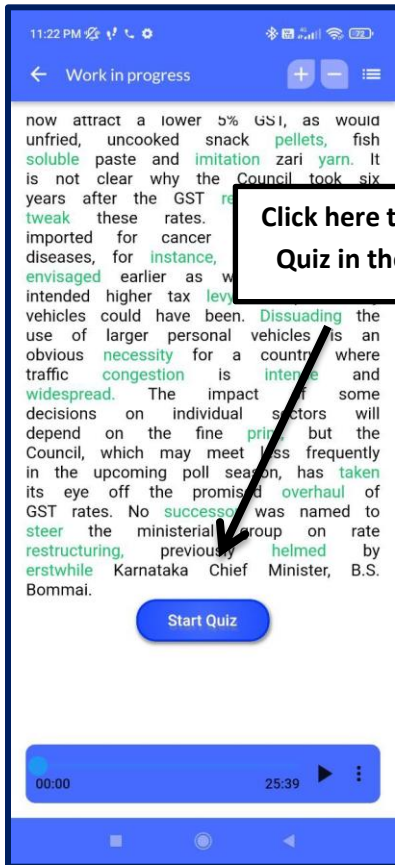
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. RCB's IPL victory on June 3, 2025, sparked massive celebrations across Bengaluru and Karnataka.
2. Within 24 hours, the joy turned to tragedy as a stampede occurred at M. Chinnaswamy Stadium on June 4, leaving 11 dead and over 50 injured.
3. The stadium was hosting a felicitation event for the RCB team, drawing thousands of fans desperate to catch a glimpse of players.
4. Most deaths were due to asphyxia and injuries in the overcrowded, suffocating environment.
5. RCB's massive fan following and emotional bond with supporters amplified crowd turnout.
6. The crowd spilled over Bengaluru's Central Business District, including roads like MG Road and Queens Road.
7. Chief Minister Siddaramaiah admitted the crowd size exceeded expectations.
8. However, blaming crowd size alone is unacceptable—this was a preventable disaster.
9. Rumours about an open-bus parade, denied by police, and conflicting messages about event access caused confusion.
10. Fans rushed toward the stadium due to lack of access at the Vidhana Soudha felicitation event.
11. Contradictory communication—entry by invitation vs. open gates—led to mass panic and chaos.
12. Poor crowd control, inadequate security, and understaffed police presence worsened the situation.
13. Authorities including the State Government, RCB, KSCA, and BCCI have offered condolences but also indulged in blame-shifting.
14. The CM has suspended top police officials responsible and announced a judicial inquiry.
15. The editorial criticizes the system, stressing that fans—the lifeblood of sports—are treated as an afterthought, and urges better planning, clear communication, and policing to avoid future tragedies.

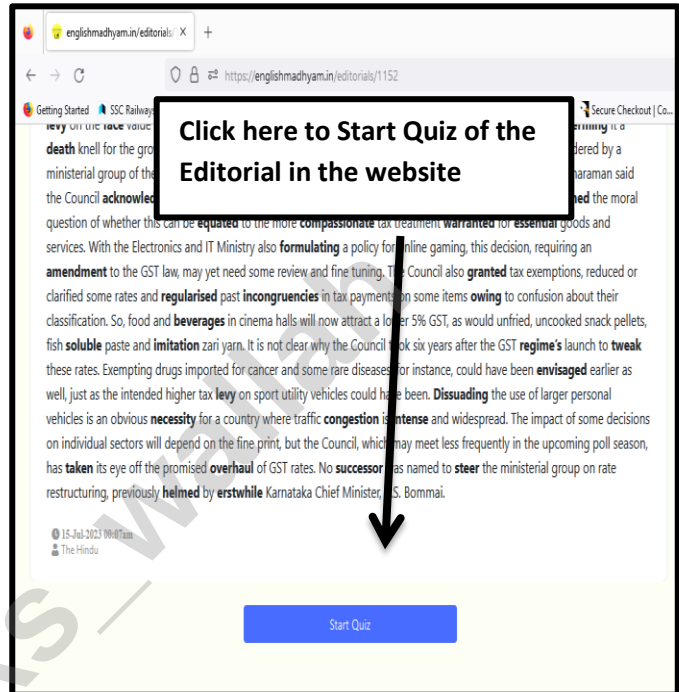
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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